

Context is Everything: From Barbados to AI Innovation

Context is Everything: From Barbados to AI Innovation

Matt Hamilton

Founder, Dharach - Civic Labs

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Who knows how to bake a cake?



Two Types of Context

The context that changed my life:

1. 🏝️ The context of being in Barbados
2. 🤖 The context we give to AI systems

Act 1: My Journey

Finding Context

From Bristol to Barbados

- 2020: Came for the beaches, stayed for the opportunity
- Working at global tech companies (IBM, Ripple, Protocol Labs, Arbitrum Foundation) from a beach in Barbados
- **The revelation:** "If I can build world-class tech from here, why can't everyone?"



My Journey

University (CompSci) → **Netsight** → **enquos**
→ **IBM** → **Ripple** → **Protocol Labs** →
Arbitrum → **Dharach**

- Building blockchain/AI systems from Barbados
- Paddleboard meetings: Best brainstorming on water
- Wukkin up with a concrete waistline



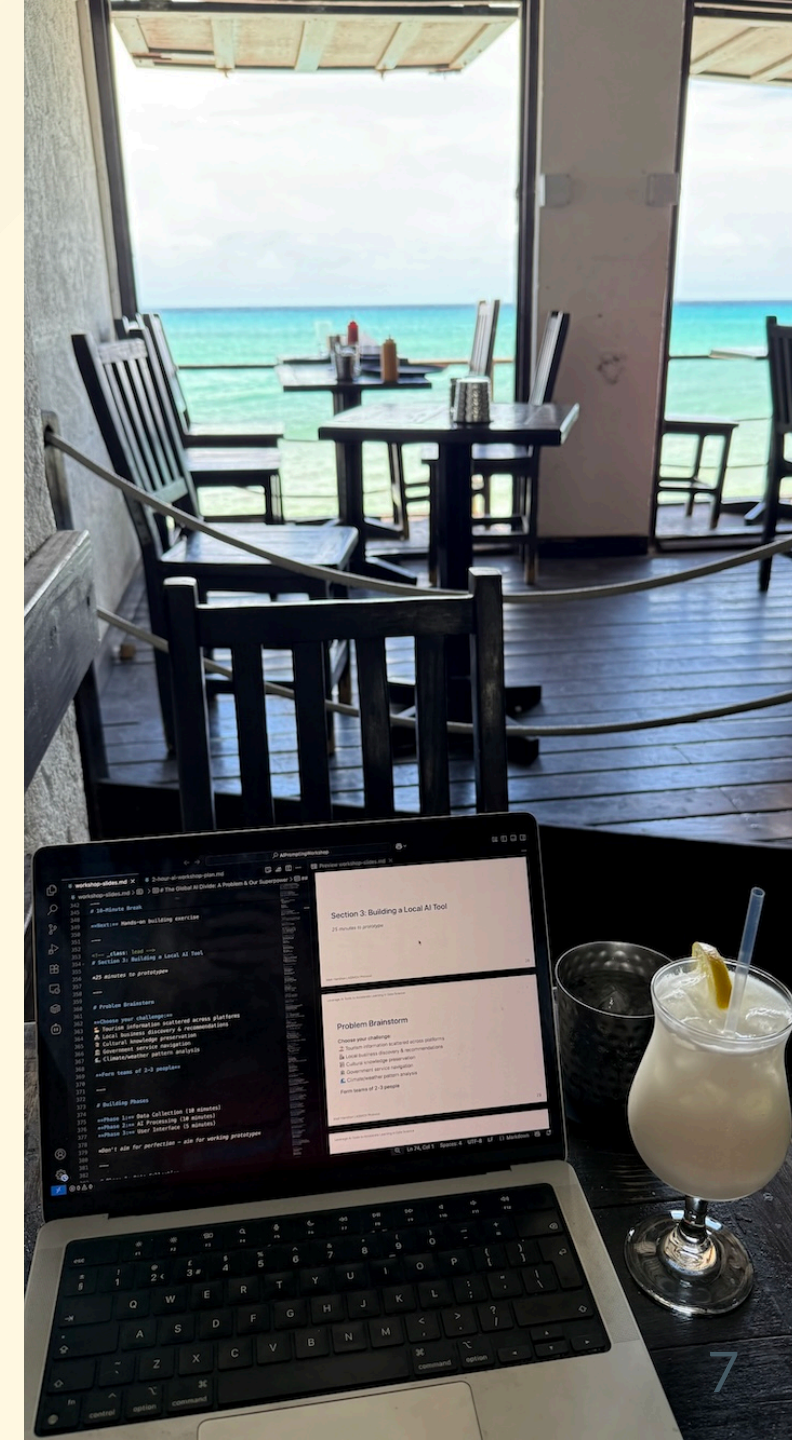
The Constraint Advantage

No massive data centers? → Build smarter systems

No billion-dollar budgets? → Solve real problems

"Limited" resources? → Unlimited creativity

"Necessity is the mother of invention" - and Barbados is full of mothers!



Kate Kallot's Prophecy

"The AI revolution is not being
written in Silicon Valley...
it's coming from Manila, from
Bridgetown, from Nairobi"

Kate Kallot, CEO of Amini
Working with GovTech Barbados



Act 2: Local Problems, Local Solutions

When Context Creates Innovation

WeOutside246.com

Problem: Events scattered on IG

Solution: AI finds and structures event data

- LLMs (OpenAI) + Python
- Instagram scraping using Apify
- Event tagging & parsing
- Scheduled tasks run on Google Cloud Run



Rosé Brunch at The View (Crop Over Season Launch) ☆

Sat, Jul 19

The View: Kitchen + Bar

Live DJ

Brunch Music Cropover

dineattheview
The View: Kitchen + Bar

View profile

SATURDAY & SUNDAY

ROSÉ Brunch

10AM - 3PM

MIMOSAS • LIVE DJ • ROSÉ BUBBLES

\$60 FOR 2 HOURS BOTTOMLESS MIMOSAS OR ROSÉ

3-COURSE SPECIAL \$160 INCLUDES 2 HOURS BOTTOMLESS MIMOSAS OR ROSÉ

Reservations: (246) 624-7749 or www.dineattheview.com

Motion: The Beach Party at Copacabana ☆

Sat, Jul 19

Copacabana, Barbados

Beach Cropover Soca Party

motion_enterpr...
992 followers

View profile

View more on Instagram

36 likes

Add a comment...

Souise, Rum & Soca x School Hall Back to School Fete ☆

Sat, Jul 19

THE Thiki Bar – Top of Rendezvous Hill, Barbados

Faith Callender, DJ Robbi, Synpa

Soca Cropover Music Fete

sousenumandsoca and _ho
2,323 followers

View profile

SCHOL HALL

SOUSE x **SCHOL HALL**

RUM & SOCA

PROMO / TICKET COLLECTION 6-9 PM

WEAR YOUR SCHOOL TIE/ATTIRE FOR CHANCES TO WIN TICKETS

THIS SATURDAY 1PM

THE BAJAN CODE COLLECTION SHIRTS AVAILABLE FOR PURCHASE

Performances by **FAITH CALLENDER** & **FRIENDS**

Music by **DJ ROBBI** WITH SPECIAL GUEST **SYNPA**

Unmasked Sandi Gras Beach Masquerade ☆

Sat, Jul 19

Paul Owens at The Beach House, Barbados

Cropover Beach Music Masquerade

unmasked_events
Paul Owens at The Beach Hc

View profile

View more on Instagram

Buzz Crop Over Edition ☆

Sat, Jul 19

Zouk Night Lounge, Barbados

Soca Cropover Music Party

zoukbarbados
11.5K followers

View profile

BUZZ

ZOUK

ENTRÉE • WINESS • MEN'S 10

Trouble in Paradise: Cropover 2025 Schedule ☆

Sat, Jul 19

Barbados

DJ C-FOUR, DJ Sinistar

Soca Cropover Music Cruise Jouvert

Brunch Beach

djcfour
Jus Jay King, Grateful Co - Lisiin' Fast (In the Moment)

View profile

CROPOVER 2025 SCHEDULE

JULY 18 TOPIN MUSIC FESTIVAL DAY

JULY 19 CROPOVER / CROOVER / PARADISE POP-UP

JULY 20 TRICKOR TREAT

JULY 21 TRICKOR TREAT

JULY 22 TRICKOR TREAT

JULY 23 TRICKOR TREAT

JULY 24 TRICKOR TREAT

JULY 25 TRICKOR TREAT

JULY 26 TRICKOR TREAT

JULY 27 TRICKOR TREAT

JULY 28 TRICKOR TREAT

JULY 29 TRICKOR TREAT

JULY 30 TRICKOR TREAT

JULY 31 TRICKOR TREAT

Watch on Instagram

LLM Data Extraction



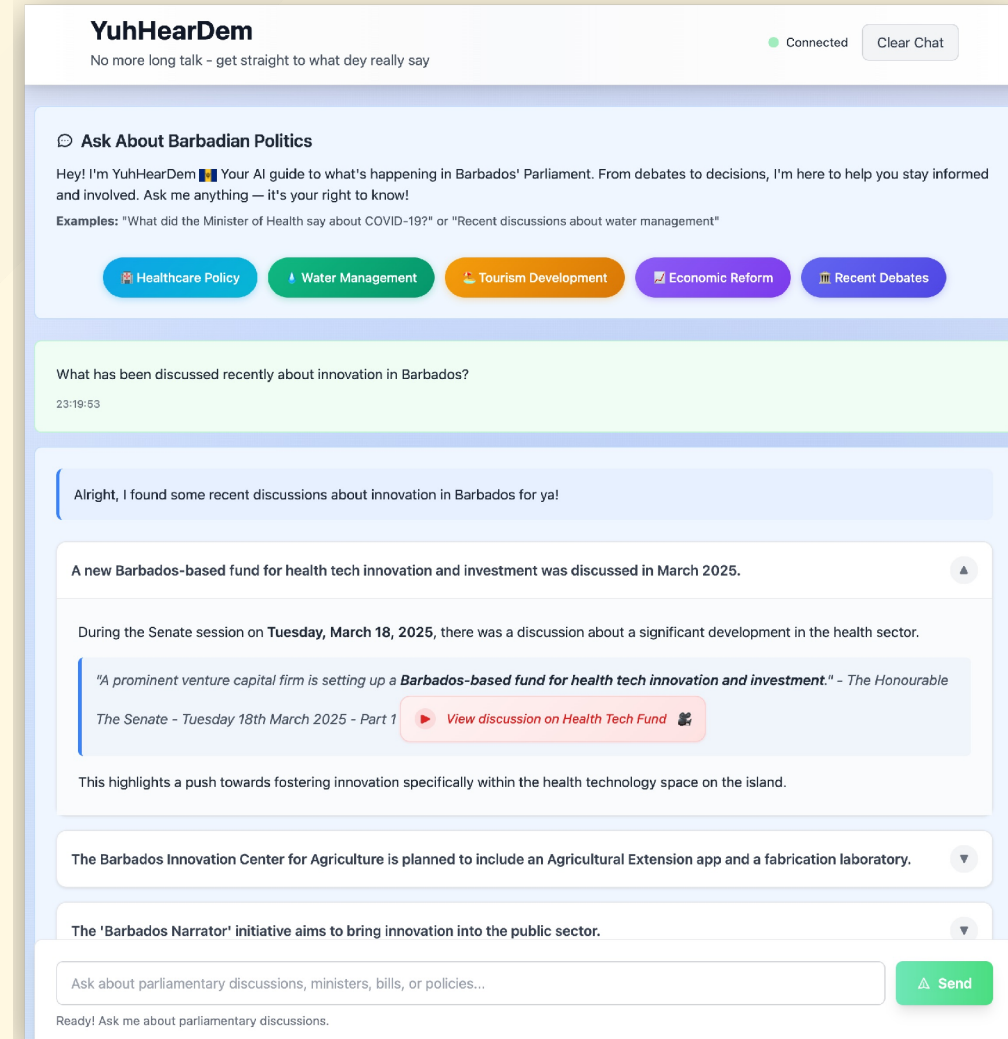
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1 {
2   "artists": [
3     "Jus Jay",
4     "Ovadose",
5     "Legacy Team",
6     "Surf Rat & Menace",
7     "C-Four",
8     "Raw Gas"
9   ],
10  "isEvent": true,
11  "location": "Copacabana Beach Club, Barbados",
12  "eventDate": "2025-07-19",
13  "eventName": "TMF Beach - Tippy Music Festival Day 1 at Copacabana Beach Club",
14  "eventType": [
15    "SOCA",
16    "CROPOVER",
17    "BEACH",
18    "MUSIC",
19    "FETE"
20  ],
21  "reasoning": "The image is a professional event poster for 'Tippy Music Festival' Day 1, clearly stating the date (19th July 2025), time (12PM-8PM), and location (Copacabana Beach Club, Barbados). The caption and hashtags reinforce the Barbados location and Crop Over context. The DJ lineup matches both the image and caption. The event is a beach party/fete with strong soca and Crop Over associations, and all details are presented in English. No conflicting location or date info is present.",
22  "confidence": 98,
23  "validUsernames": [],
24  "extractedContent": {
25    "text": "The beach vibes 'bout to be serious! 🌴🔥TMF Weekend Kicks off on Saturday, July 19 with Day 1: beachwear, big vibes and pure bliss 🌴🌴🌴Here's your DJ lineup bringing the heat to @copacabanabb \n\n Jus Jay\n Ovadose\n Surf Rat & Menace\n Legacy Team\n DJ C Four\n Raw Gas\n\nDon't get caught outside 🌴 grab those tix NOW cuz entry by ticket only! 🌴🌴🌴 Warning: This ain't no ordinary beach party - issa BEACH FETE. 🌴🌴Vibes? Mad. Energy? Certified. Let's go! 🌴🌴\nDAY 1 - TMF Beach 🌴\nSaturday, July 19, 2025 🌴 12PM - 8PM 🌴 $120.00 BBD\n\nPurchase online 🌴 link in bio or at these official Box Offices: \n\n Sole Addiction - Broadstreet, Bridgetown \n\n Forever Blessed - Tudor Street, Bridgetown \n\n Intermix - Sky Mall and Sheraton Mall \n\n Supernova - Sheraton Mall \n\n 11th Street Boutique - Dome Mall \n\n DSK Clothing Wear - Kensington Mall \n\n Day and Night Boutique - The Walk, Welches \n\n Backyard Restaurant - Hastings \n\n Imart Pharmacy - Six Roads, Lanterns & The Walk, Welches \n\n Excuse Me Miss - Roebuck Street, Bridgetown \n\n Rubis Coverly \n\n\n🔥 TMF WEEKEND PASS (Day 1 + Day 2) \n\n $265.00 BBD \n\n\n#TMF2025 #TMFBeach #Day1Loading #TippyMusicFestival #SupportLocal 🌴 #TMFBarbados #TippyMusicFestivalBarbados #TippyBarbados #TwistedEntertainment #TwistedBarbados #TwistedFam #Barbados #Cropover #GetYourTickets \n\n Edited - 1 d \n\n👍👍👍 Liked by jusjayking and 264 others \n\n 1 day ago \n\n🗨️ Add a comment... \n\n📌 Post"
```

YuhHearDem

Problem: Parliament transcripts are unreadable

Solution: AI makes them searchable & structured

- Gemini + LangChain + MongoDB
- Topic segmentation
- Queryable public record
- Links to YouTube videos



Context is Everything: From Barbados to AI Innovation

Session Knowledge Graph

39 entities • 86 relationships • Click and drag to explore

innovators in Barbados
Type: PERSON
Properties:
• description: Individuals or groups who create new ideas or meth...
• type: PERSON
URI: INNOVATORS_IN_BARBADOS

Scroll to zoom • Drag to pan • Click nodes for details

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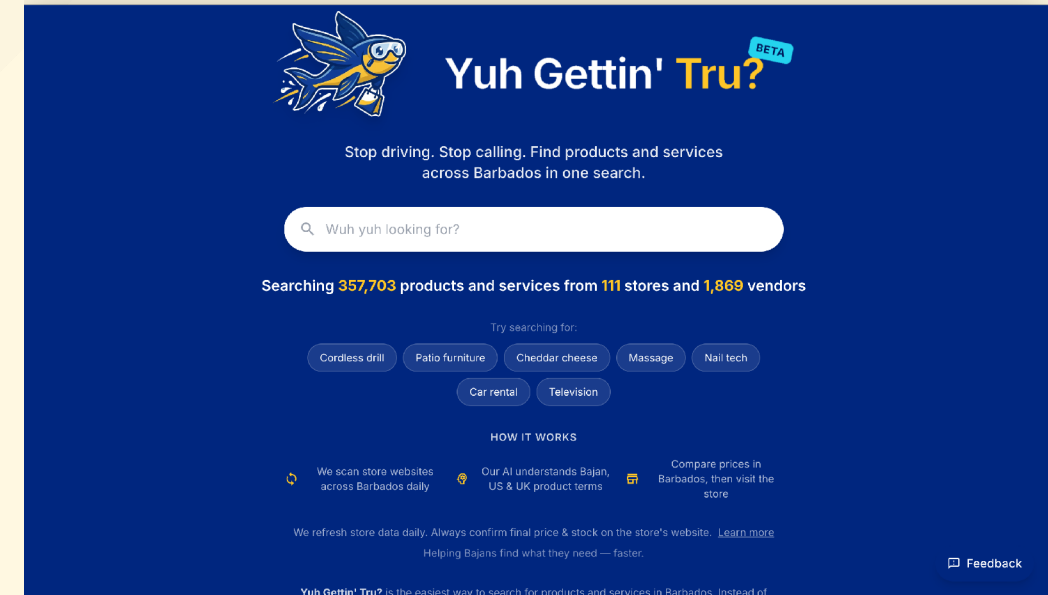
14

Yuh Gettin Tru?

Problem: Product discovery is friction

Solution: One search across Barbados stores + vendors

- 350k+ products & services across 110+ stores
- 1,800+ Instagram vendors (micro-business discovery)
- Semantic search: Bajan / US / UK terms + intent ranking



Context is Everything: From Barbados to AI Innovation



Yuh Gettin' Tru?

 Cordless drill



All (22)Products (20)Vendors (2)

 Filters

 Sort

 Type

Showing top 22 results for 'Cordless drill'

Looking for something specific?

Drill Kits

Tool Retailers

 Share



CORDLESS DRILL COMPACT
DCD794B

 Marshall's Trading

BBD \$434.12

VIEW

 96% Match

- DEWALT compact cordless drill – exact match.



Dewalt 20V Cordless Drill Kit
DCD800D2

 Marshall's Trading

BBD \$990.60

VIEW

 96% Match

- DEWALT cordless drill kit with batteries – exact match.

 Add to home screen

Search faster, no app store needed

INSTALL



20-Volt MAX Atomic
Compact Cordless Drill...

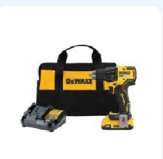
 Do it Best Barbados

BBD \$805.10

VIEW

 95% Match

- Exact cordless drill driver kit, perfect match.



Cordless Drill Compact
Dcd793d

 Marshall's Trading

BBD \$531.48

VIEW

 95% Match

- DEWALT compact cordless drill – perfect match.



18-volt Lxt Lithium-ion 1/2

PRODUCT



20-Volt Compact Cordless

PRODUCT

Feedback

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Act 3: Context Engineering

The Technical Magic

What is Context Engineering?

"Prompting is what you say — context is what the model knows when you say it"

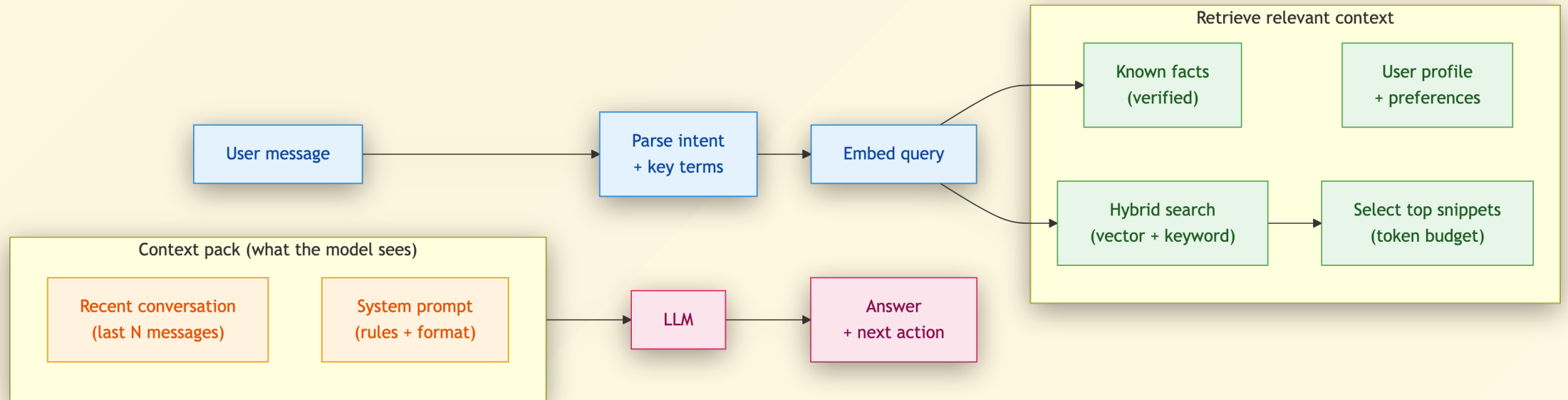
Like giving someone the right cookbook before asking them to bake

For your work:

- Data cleaning = preserving context
- Data engineering = structuring knowledge
- Compliance / Privacy = ethical context

Building Context for AI

From a user message to a clean context pack



- Query Embedding → Vector Search → Build Context → LLM Call

Prompting Challenge

Let's see how well you can talk to an AI!

Clean the Data!

Dataset Issues:

-  Mixed date formats
-  Inconsistent phone numbers
-  Location variations
-  Missing values
-  Invalid entries

Goal: Write the best prompt to clean it all.

Rules & Scoring

- 🕒 20 minutes
- 🔄 Unlimited submissions
- 🧠 Gemini 2.5 Pro will score
- 🏆 Best score wins!

Scoring metrics: Formatting, completeness, accuracy, structure

bit.ly/bim-ai-workshop

Your Context, Your Superpower

The Barbados Advantage

We're Natural Context Engineers

- We code-switch daily (formal English ↔ Bajan)
- We bridge cultures constantly
- We understand nuance and context intuitively

Our constraints force us to be more creative with context



You Are Uniquely Positioned

You've been:

-  Learning the tools
-  Understanding data at a deep level
-  Working with real-world applications

You have what Silicon Valley doesn't:

- Local context, Cultural understanding, Real problems to solve

The Challenge

Kate Kallot said:

"The AI revolution is being written in Bridgetown"

Not despite our context, but because of it

What problems will you solve that only someone from here could solve?

Final Thought

I came to Barbados for a different life context.

I discovered that context is our competitive advantage.

In AI, context is everything — and you have context that the world needs.



Contact & Resources

Matt Hamilton

- GitHub: [@hammertoe](#)
- LinkedIn: [Matt Hamilton](#)
- Website: [dharach.com](#)

Learn More:

- Yuh Gettin Tru?: [yuhgettintru.com](#)
- YuhHearDem: [yuhheardem.com](#)
- WeOutside246: [weoutside246.com](#)